

# Compare characteristics of living and non-living things and examine the differences between the life cycles of plants and animals

## Learning intention

- compare characteristics of living and non-living things and examine the differences between the life cycles of plants and animals.

## Teach and model

- classifying a collection of objects as living, once living or non-living and explaining their reasoning.
- comparing the physical characteristics of an animal such as a frog or moth with its activity at different stages of its life cycle.
- representing stages of a plant or animal's life cycle using drawings, digital photographs, graphic organisers or concrete materials.

## Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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## Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

## Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.